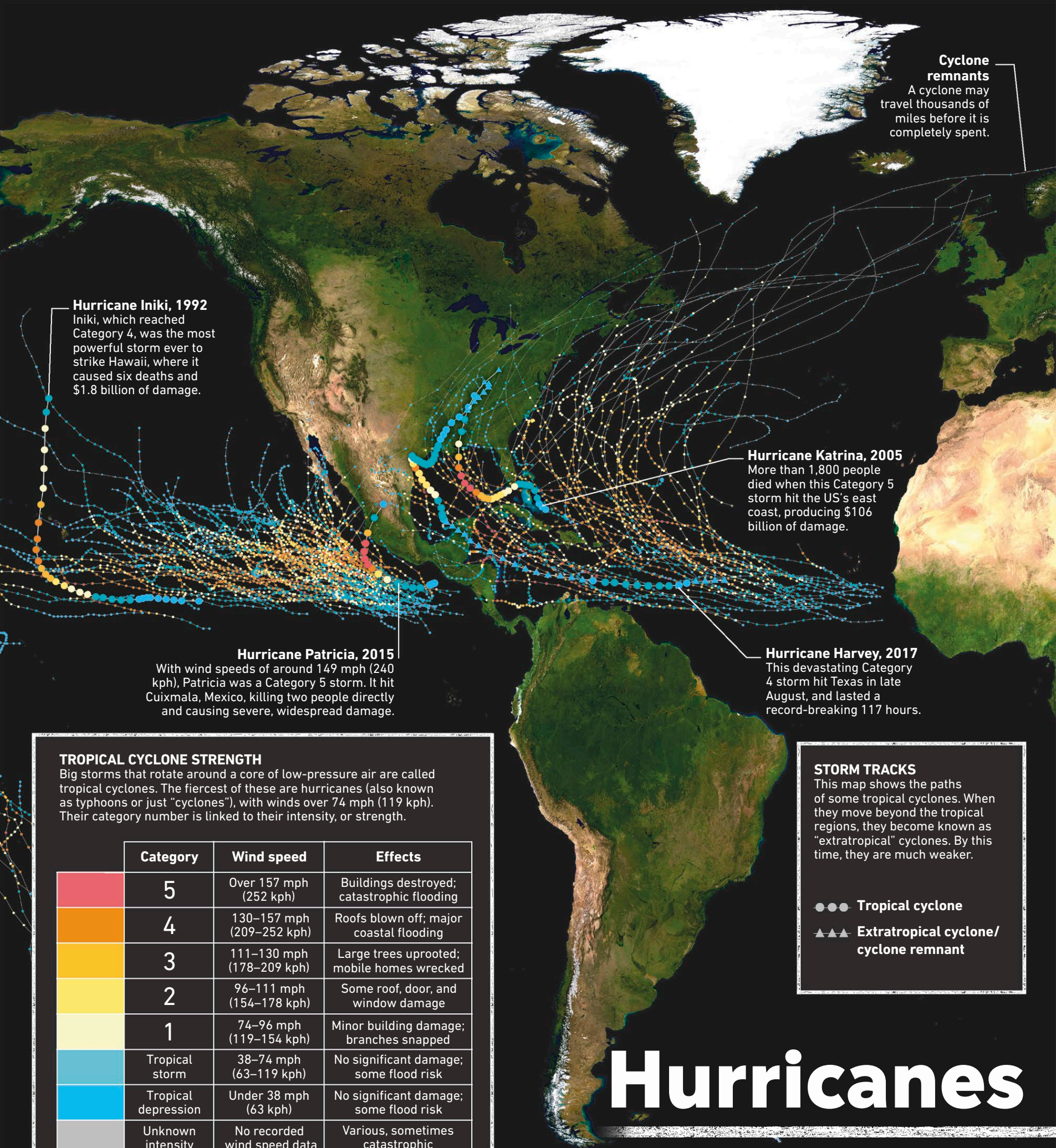




Cyclone remnants
A cyclone may travel thousands of miles before it is completely spent.

Hurricane Iniki, 1992
Iniki, which reached Category 4, was the most powerful storm ever to strike Hawaii, where it caused six deaths and \$1.8 billion of damage.

Hurricane Katrina, 2005
More than 1,800 people died when this Category 5 storm hit the US's east coast, producing \$106 billion of damage.

Hurricane Patricia, 2015
With wind speeds of around 149 mph (240 kph), Patricia was a Category 5 storm. It hit Cuixmala, Mexico, killing two people directly and causing severe, widespread damage.

Hurricane Harvey, 2017
This devastating Category 4 storm hit Texas in late August, and lasted a record-breaking 117 hours.

TROPICAL CYCLONE STRENGTH

Big storms that rotate around a core of low-pressure air are called tropical cyclones. The fiercest of these are hurricanes (also known as typhoons or just "cyclones"), with winds over 74 mph (119 kph). Their category number is linked to their intensity, or strength.

	Category	Wind speed	Effects
	5	Over 157 mph (252 kph)	Buildings destroyed; catastrophic flooding
	4	130–157 mph (209–252 kph)	Roofs blown off; major coastal flooding
	3	111–130 mph (178–209 kph)	Large trees uprooted; mobile homes wrecked
	2	96–111 mph (154–178 kph)	Some roof, door, and window damage
	1	74–96 mph (119–154 kph)	Minor building damage; branches snapped
	Tropical storm	38–74 mph (63–119 kph)	No significant damage; some flood risk
	Tropical depression	Under 38 mph (63 kph)	No significant damage; some flood risk
	Unknown intensity	No recorded wind speed data	Various, sometimes catastrophic

STORM TRACKS

This map shows the paths of some tropical cyclones. When they move beyond the tropical regions, they become known as "extratropical" cyclones. By this time, they are much weaker.

- Tropical cyclone
- ▲▲▲ Extratropical cyclone/ cyclone remnant

Hurricanes